Nathan Acks

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Denver, CO, United States
nathan.acks@cardboard-iguana.com
https://cardboard-iguana.com
@necopinus

Basics

Nathan Acks is a security engineer and penetration tester with broad cross-domain experience. His offensive security work spans web applications, thick clients, mobile applications, and smart contracts, blending manual and automated techniques to assess risk, build threat models, and defeat the security mechanisms of the systems he evaluates. He is a deliberate generalist, emphasizing breadth and flexibility of ability rather than single-domain expertise. Nathan has developed and led a variety of trainings, ranging from multi-day security trainings for client software development teams to one-on-one workshops on operational security for non-technical staff. Before working for Bureau Veritas Cybersecurity, Nathan helped found the IT & Security Team at a national nonprofit, crafting organization-wide security policies, trainings, and strategy documents in partnership with legal and executive leadership. This experience grounds his technical work in deep understanding of real organizational and business needs.

Technical Proficiency

Topline Skills	Intermediate	Keywords: Security Solutions, Organizational Leadership, Service Excellence
Areas of Expertise	Intermediate	Keywords: Vulnerability Assessments, Investigations & Research, Smart Contract Audits, Technical Project Management, Risk Analysis & Management, Technical Documentation, Strategic Business Partnerships, Strategy & Execution, Stakeholder Communication
Penetration Testing	Intermediate	Keywords: Burp Suite, Kali Linux, Metasploit, Python, Solidity
Cybersecurity	Intermediate	Keywords: Incident Response, PCI DSS, Security Training, Security Policy
IT Operations	Intermediate	Keywords: Linux Administration, Database Administration, Amazon Web Services, Google Workspace, Office 365, Technical Support

Certifications

May 2022 — CompTIA, Security+ (2022 –2025)

Professional Experience

Feb 2024–Present — Security Engineer II, Bureau Veritas Cybersecurity North America, https://cybersecurity.bureauveritas.com

- Coordinated scoping calls and process improvements as a technical project manager for a major global client.
- Developed and lead multi-day security trainings for client software development teams.
- Led teams of 1 - 4 engineers during multi-week engagements covering multiple services and applications.
- Developed in-house and open source tools to aid penetration test automation and effectiveness.
- Notable achievements in the position include:
  - Developed a standardized testing environment using Nix flakes.
  - Maintained an offline knowledge base for use by engineers during on-site engagements without direct internet access.

May 2022–Feb 2024 — Security Engineer I, Bureau Veritas Cybersecurity North America, https://cybersecurity.bureauveritas.com

- Worked closely with other application security engineers to perform reviews and tests on web applications and thick clients.
- Created threat models that resulted in more secure application design.
- Analyzed and presented results of testing to team members, managers, and customers.

Jun 2016–May 2022 Director of IT, The Public Interest Network, https://publicinterestnetwork.org

- Founded and oversaw the IT & Security team, crafting organization-wide security policies, documentation, and trainings in collaboration with the Legal team and the President's Office.
- Held bottom-line responsibility for the roll-out, maintenance, security, and support of IT systems used by all staff, including email, user authentication, document management, and custom internal applications.
- Served as the technical point-of-contact for IT-related PCI DSS issues.
- Investigated and remediated potential IT security incidents.
- Notable achievements in the position include:
  - Oversaw the creation of an internal system for managing the full lifecycle of accounts in services managed by the IT & Security team.
  - Oversaw the migration from a legacy vendor email system to Google Workspace, and from a legacy LDAP system to Okta.
  - Managed the roll-out of two-factor authentication to all staff, the transition to Microsoft 365, and the migration of multiple office-based phone systems to Zoom Phone.

Oct 2009–Jun 2016 Manager of Online Outreach Technology, The Public Interest Network, https://publicinterestnetwork.org

- Provided data analysis, database development, and IT vendor management for the organization's digital organizing program.
- Managed multiple Linux servers running mission-critical applications including LDAP/GOsa, MySQL, NFS, Postfix, Apache, CiviCRM, WebGUI, and Tenable Security Center.
- Maintained a large library of custom SQL and PL/SQL scripts for reporting and data import, export, and clean-up.
- Provided wide-ranging support in the development of content and outreach strategies as part of a rapid response organizing team.
- Notable achievements in the position include:
  - Oversaw the migrations of an in-house constituent relationship management (CRM) and action system to a vendor CRM (Convio, and later Salsa).
  - Led a project that integrated vendor CRM databases with a separate system hosted by ROI Solutions.

Education

Apr 2005–May 2009 Master, Applied Mathematics, University of Colorado, Denver, CO, https://ucdenver.edu

Jul 1999–Dec 2003 Bachelor, Theoretical Physics, University of Colorado, Denver, CO, https://ucdenver.edu

Community Involvement

Apr 2020–Present Yakshaver, Yak Collective, https://www.yakcollective.org

- Maintained a static website for the organization using GitHub, Netlify, Cloudinary, and IFTTT.
- Helped design and implement externally-facing project pages.
- Helped set up and maintain a member database using Knack.
- Part of the core team responsible for managing the organizational treasury using Colony and Gnosis Safe.